Experiment 6: Library Book Issue System – Automation Suite & Workflow Options

Aim

To build and document the automation layer for the Library Book Issue System using Zoho Creator workflow options, covering form workflows, schedules, approvals, payments where applicable, blueprints, batch workflows, report workflows, and custom functions.

1. Objective

This experiment demonstrates the use of Zoho Creator workflow options to automate library operations from book issue registration through due-date reminders, return approval or verification, inventory updates, and transaction closure.

2. Workflow Mapping Overview

Workflow Type	Configuration / Purpose
Form Workflow	On_Book_Issue_Submit_Workflow – sends an acknowledgement and alerts library staff when an issu e record is create
Schedule	Daily_Due_Date_Reminder_Schedule – checks due and overdue books and sends reminders where contact details ar
Approval	Special_Issue_Approval – manages approval for renewals or special borrowing requests, if required by library policy.
Payment	Library_Fine_Payment_Workflow – records or tracks overdue fine payments if the application support s fines; otherwise
Blueprint	Book_Issue_Lifecycle_Blueprint – defines stages and transitions for issued, renewal requested, retur ed, and closed
Batch Workflow	Bulk_Overdue_Check_Batch – processes groups of issue records to identify overdue books and upda te flags.
Report Workflow	OnEdit_Update_Return_Status_Workflow – recalculates issue status and availability after relevant re ort edits.
Function	Send_Book_Return_Reminder_Function – reusable Deluge function for sending due-date or overdue notifications.

3. Detailed Workflow Configurations & Evidence

Form Workflow (On_Book_Issue_Submit_Workflow)

Purpose: Triggers when a new book issue record is submitted in the Book_Issue_Form. Action: Sends a confirmation to the member and a notification to library staff, if email addresses and mail actions are configured.

Schedule Workflow (Daily_Due_Date_Reminder_Schedule)

Purpose: Runs daily at a configured time to find books approaching their due date or already overdue. Action: Sends reminders to members or library staff using the issue record's due date and member contact information.

Approval Workflow (Special_Issue_Approval)

Purpose: Supports approval for special borrowing requests or book renewals when library policy requires staff authorization. Events: Can include submission, approver review, approval notification, and rejection notification.

Payment Workflow (Library_Fine_Payment_Workflow)

Purpose: Tracks overdue fine payments if the application includes a fine field or payment integration. Action: Updates payment status after the payment is recorded or verified. If fines are not part of the application, this workflow may be excluded.

Blueprint (Book_Issue_Lifecycle_Blueprint)

Purpose: Controls the movement of an issue record through library transaction stages. Stages and transitions: Issued → Renewal Requested (optional) → Returned → Closed. An overdue flag can be handled through the schedule workflow.

Batch Workflow (Bulk_Overdue_Check_Batch)

Purpose: Processes issue records in batches to identify records whose due date has passed and whose return date is blank. Action: Marks matching records as overdue, subject to the fields and limits configured in the application.

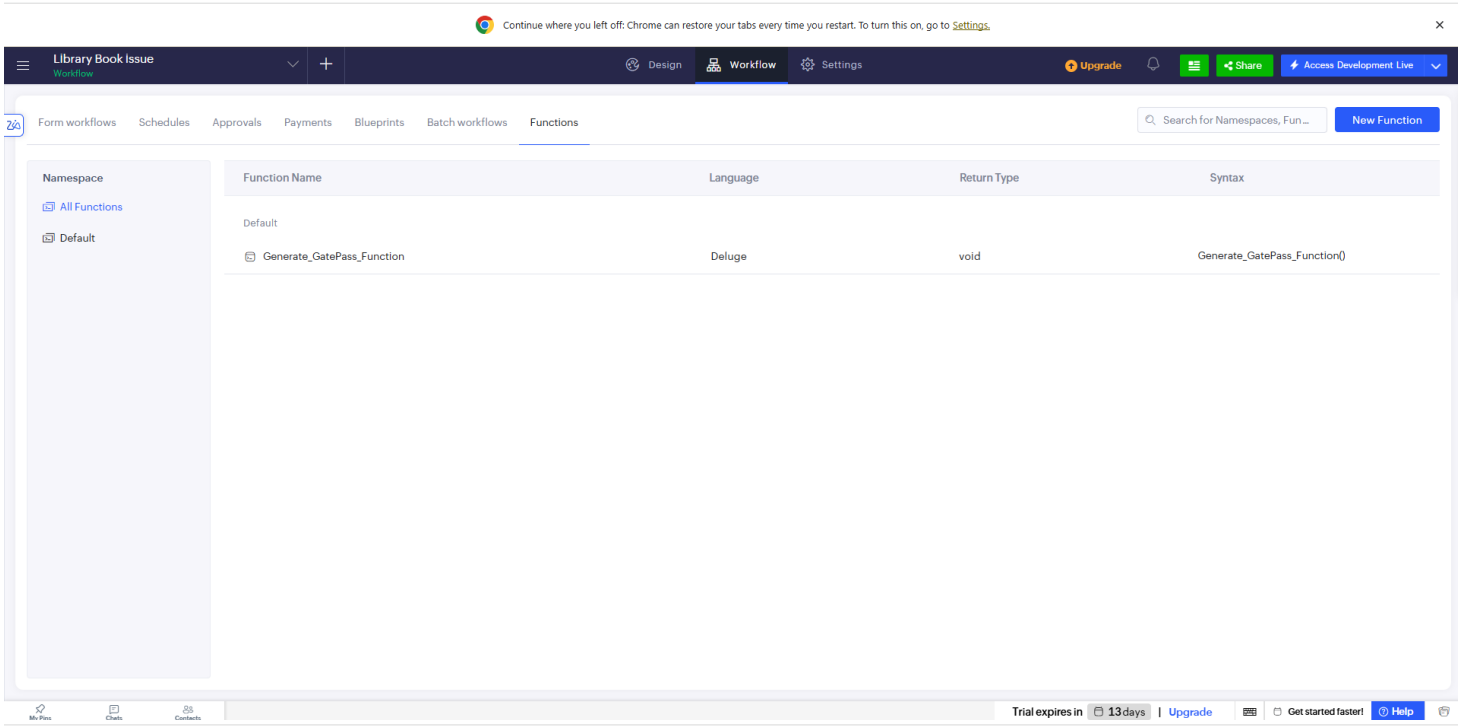
Report Workflow (OnEdit_Update_Return_Status_Workflow)

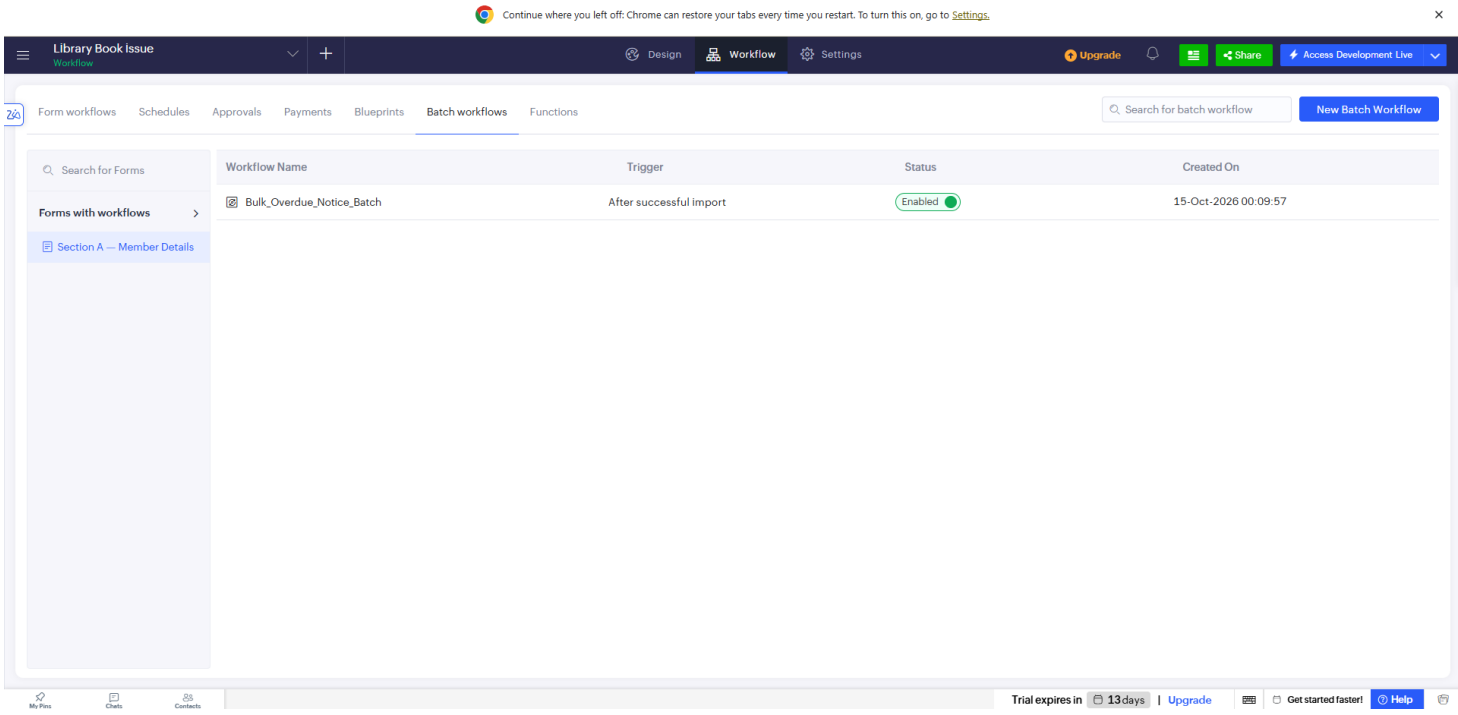
Purpose: Rechecks issue status when a record is edited through a report. Action: When a return date or issue status changes, updates the transaction status and, where configured, the related book availability.

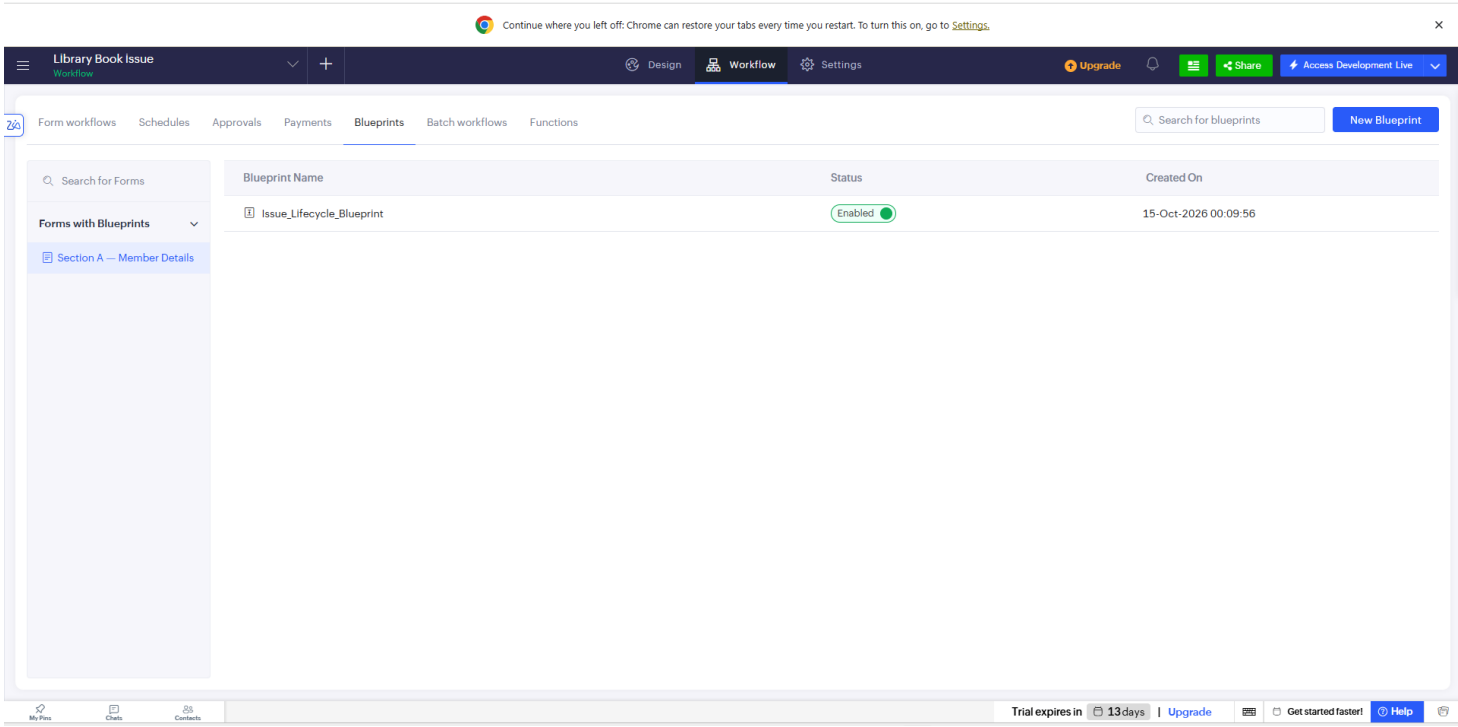
Function (Send_Book_Return_Reminder_Function)

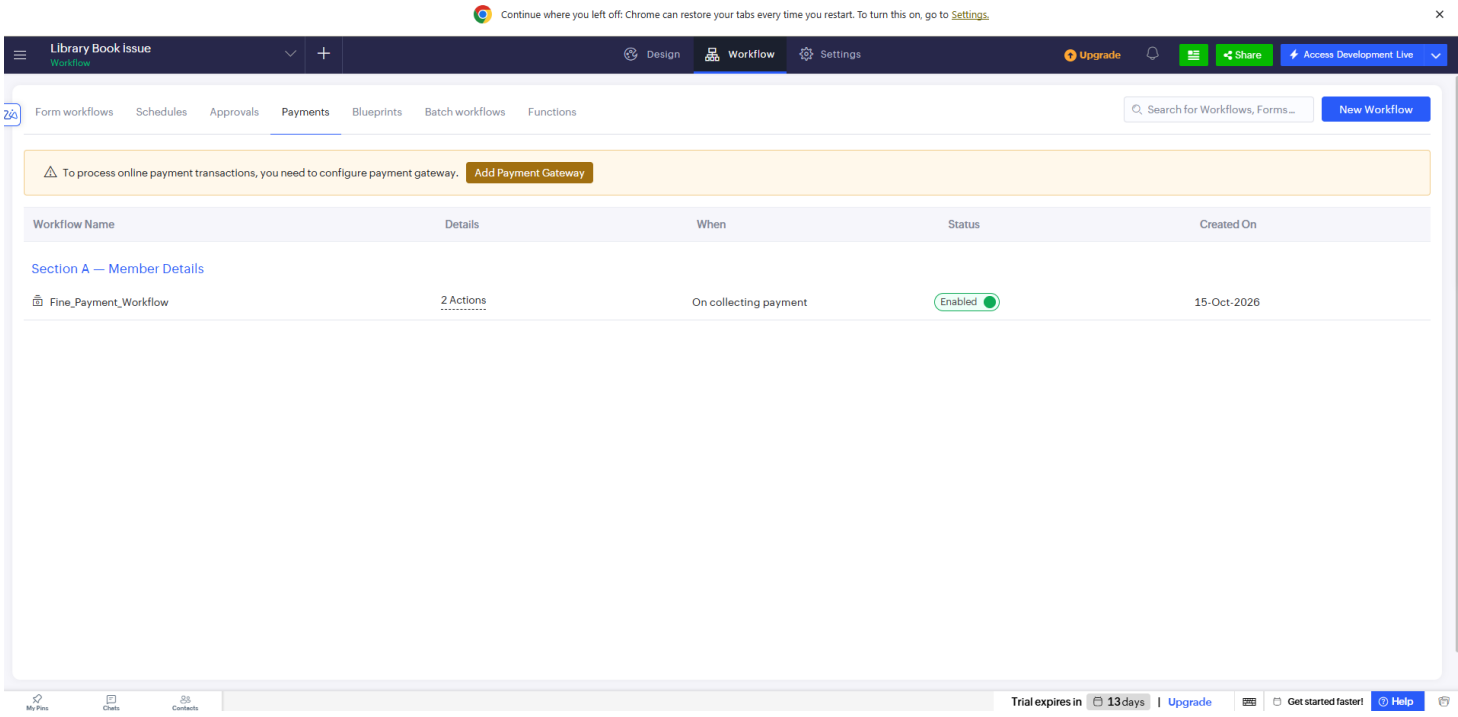
Purpose: Provides reusable Deluge logic for sending due-date or overdue reminders. Inputs may include the issue record ID, member name, email address, book title, and due date. Use the exact field link names configured in the app.

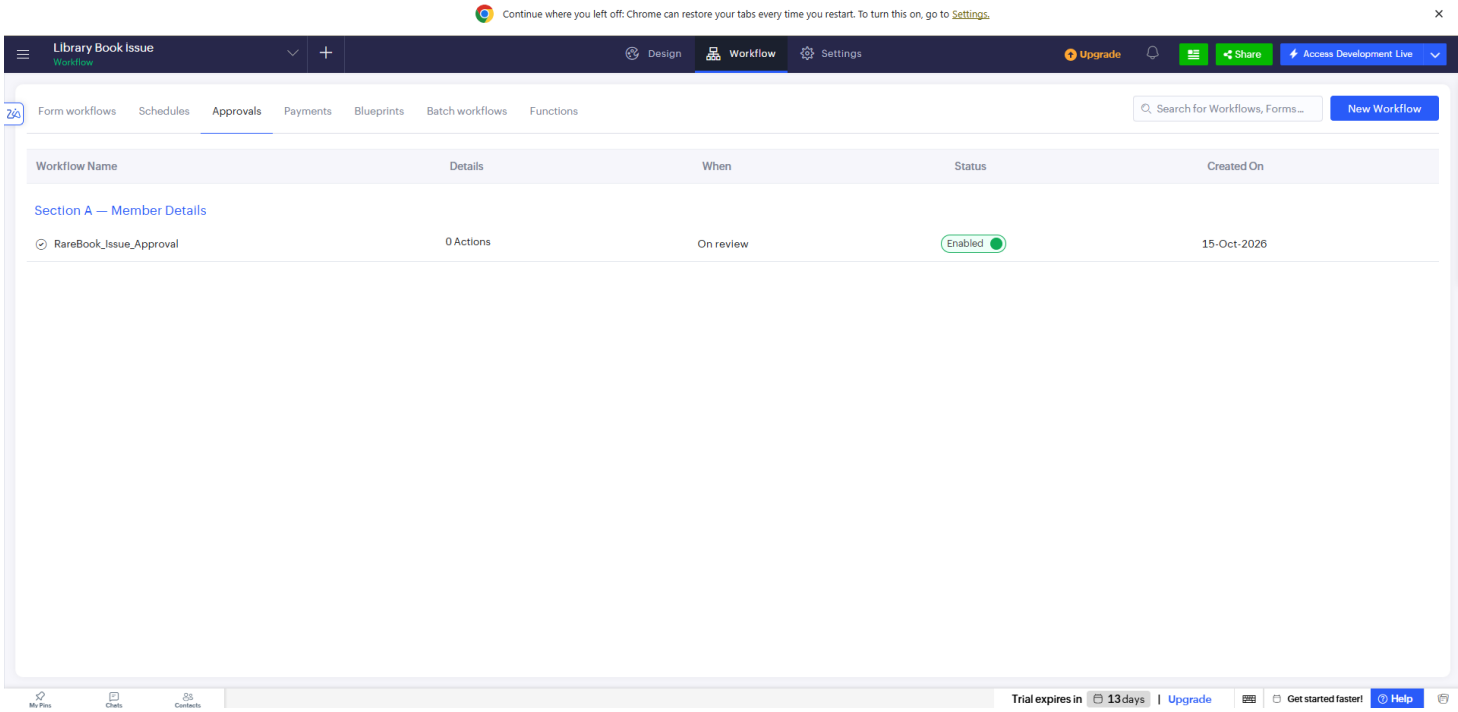
Screenshots

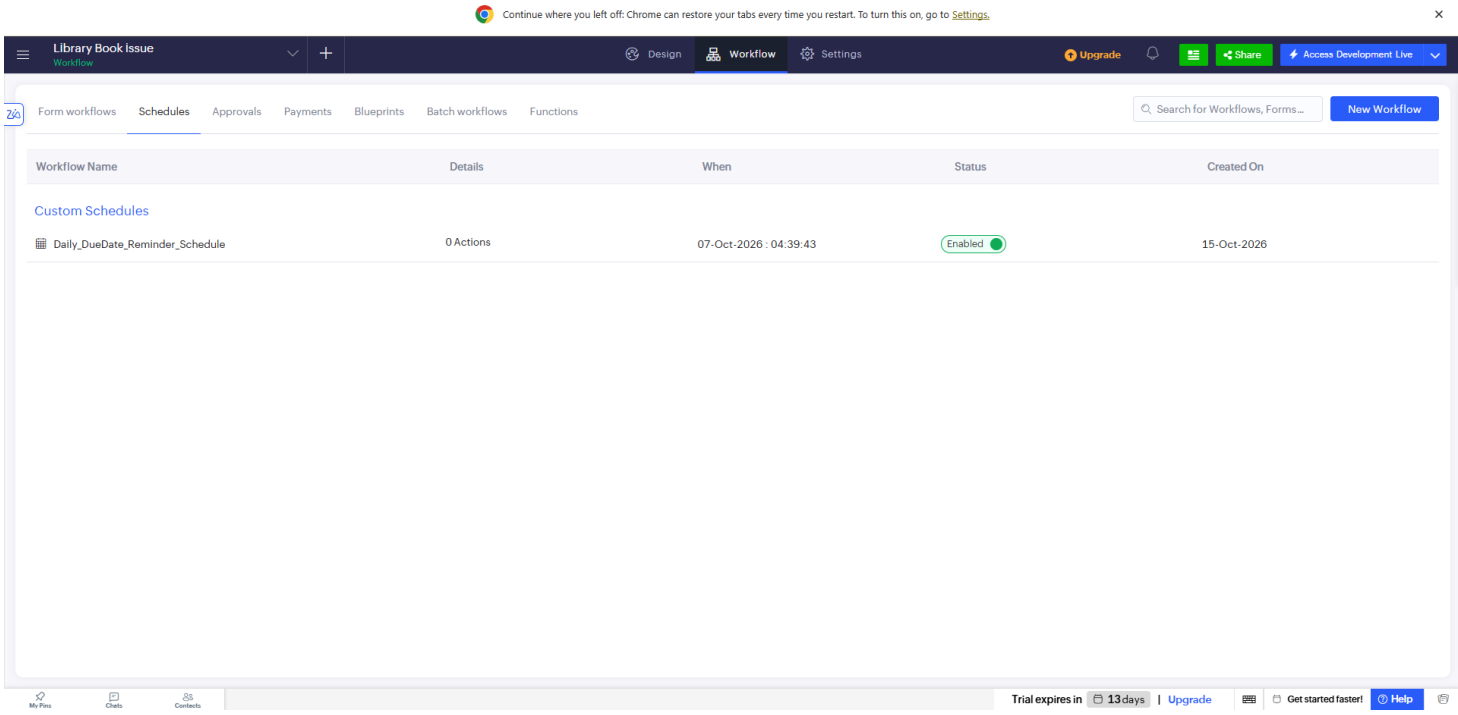


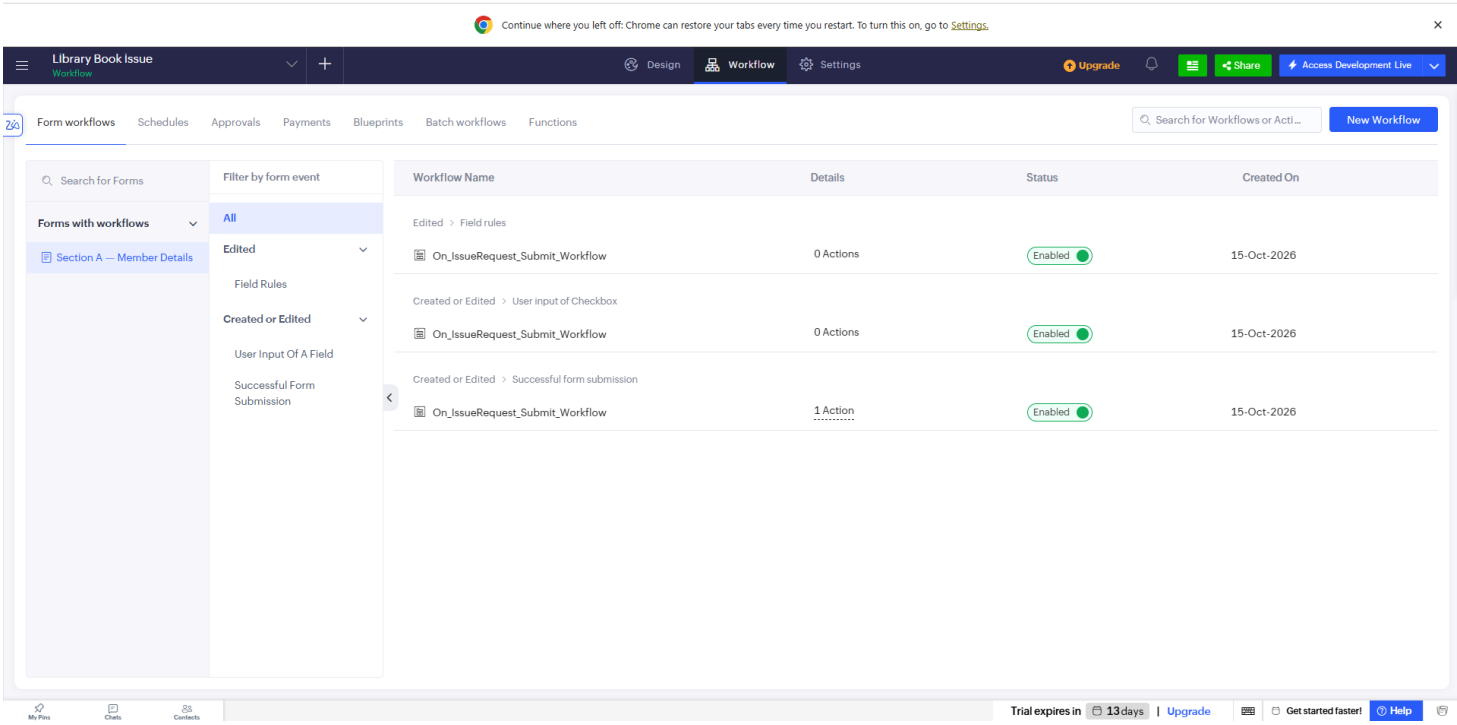



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Library Book Issue
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Batch workflows
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Section A — Member Details
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New Workflow
To process online payment transactions, you need to configure payment gateway.
Add Payment Gateway
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Section A — Member Details
Fine_Payment_Workflow
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Result

The automation suite for the Library Book Issue System has been designed and documented using Zoho Creator workflow options. The proposed workflows support issue acknowledgements, due-date reminders, optional renewal approvals, overdue checking, return-status updates, and reusable notification functions. Configure and test each workflow with the actual application fields before recording it as implemented.